APPSC Answer Secrets

Measured from **3,517 APPSC questions with the Commission's own keys** (Group 1, Group 2, the department screening tests and the AP History previous papers), and checked against **16,062 UPSC and state-PSC questions**. Every percentage is "how often the key agreed", with the count beside it.

> **Read this first.** Nothing here replaces knowing the fact. These are **tie-breakers for the questions you half-know**: when two options survive, they tell you which one the examiner usually keys. A pattern is worth trusting when it holds in *both* columns (APPSC and other exams) and on a decent count - those are marked **strong**; small or one-sided counts are marked **weak**.

0. The negative-marking rule that decides when to guess

APPSC papers print "Negative marks: 1/3" - a wrong answer costs a third of a mark.

What you can rule out	Chance of a hit	Expected marks for a guess	Do it?
Nothing (blind guess among 4)	25%	0.25 - 0.75/3 = **0.00**	No gain - skip
1 option surely wrong (3 left)	33%	0.33 - 0.67/3 = **+0.11**	Yes
2 options surely wrong (2 left)	50%	0.50 - 0.50/3 = **+0.33**	Always
2 left + a strong pattern below (about 60%)	60%	0.60 - 0.40/3 = **+0.47**	Always

So: **never guess blind; always guess once you can strike out one option.** The patterns below push a 50-50 to about 60-70.

1. Option shapes - how often each kind of option is the key

When an option is ...	APPSC	Other exams	Blind chance	Verdict
"None of the above / None of these"	**7%** (3/41)	8% (58/685)	25%	**strong**: almost never - strike it first
"Neither 1 nor 2"	**13%** (5/39)	8% (18/223)	25%	**strong**: rarely the key
"Both 1 and 2"	**54%** (66/122)	52% (346/669)	25%	**strong**: the key about half the time
"All of the above"	**36%** (5/14)	67% (118/176)	25%	**strong** in other exams (2 in 3); APPSC count small
The longest option (clearly longest)	**30%** (770/2592)	27% (3340/12262)	25%	slight lean - last resort
The shortest option	**23%** (541/2397)	23% (2538/11094)	25%	no edge
The option sharing most words with the other three	**35%** (49/140)	33% (233/712)	25%	**strong**: the 'centre' option is keyed 1 in 3
The option repeating most words of the question	**29%** (73/248)	24% (248/1021)	25%	**weak** - don't rely on it

- **The centre-option trick:** examiners build three wrong options by changing one detail of the right one, so the right option tends to share words with all the others. ("Gautamiputra Satakarni / Vasishthiputra Pulumavi / Gautamiputra Yajna Sri / Vasishthiputra Satakarni" - the key is often the one whose two halves each appear elsewhere.)
- **Strike "None of the above" and "Neither" first** - that alone turns a blind 25% into 33% and makes the guess worth taking.

2. Numbers and years in the options

Options are ...	smallest	2nd	3rd	largest	count
Numbers / % - APPSC	16%	28%	29%	27%	366
Numbers / % - other exams	21%	27%	29%	23%	1356
Years - APPSC	20%	32%	21%	27%	120
Years - other exams	18%	34%	34%	15%	375

- **The smallest number is the key least often** (APPSC 16%, others 21%) - **strong**. Between the smallest and a middle value, lean middle.
- **Years: the earliest year is rarely keyed** (APPSC 20%); the 2nd and 3rd years carry two-thirds of keys. Examiners put the true year in the middle and pad with one earlier and one later decoy.
- The "two close values" folk trick (pick one of the two nearest numbers) gives no edge: APPSC 48% against 50% chance.

3. Which option number is keyed

	1	2	3	4	count
APPSC - all questions	27%	27%	24%	21%	3517
APPSC - NOT / INCORRECT questions	21%	23%	22%	35%	279
Other exams - NOT / INCORRECT questions	20%	23%	25%	32%	1542
APPSC - one-liner	27%	27%	24%	21%	3120
APPSC - sequence	30%	37%	23%	10%	30
APPSC - statement options	16%	27%	27%	29%	73
APPSC - how many	32%	23%	20%	25%	65
APPSC - assertion	47%	34%	15%	4%	53
APPSC - statements	28%	24%	30%	18%	126
APPSC - match	37%	37%	14%	11%	35

- **In NOT / INCORRECT / EXCEPT questions, option 4 is the key about 1 time in 3** (APPSC 35%, others 32%) - **strong**. Examiners write three true statements first and put the false one last. If two options survive in a NOT question and one is option 4, take option 4.
- Across all APPSC questions option 4 is the **least** used (21%); options 1 and 2 the most. In an ordinary question, do not default to D.

4. Statement questions ("Consider the following statements")

How many statements are true

APPSC

	0 true	1 true	2 true	3 true	4 true	count
2 statements	11%	48%	41%	0%	0%	27
3 statements	3%	8%	59%	31%	0%	39
4 statements	5%	19%	40%	28%	9%	43

Other exams

	0 true	1 true	2 true	3 true	4 true	count
2 statements	10%	46%	44%	0%	0%	197
3 statements	8%	27%	33%	31%	0%	99
4 statements	0%	17%	12%	47%	23%	248

- **A statement in an APPSC set is true 62% of the time** (others 67%). With no idea about a statement, lean "true".
- **"All false / Neither / None" is rare** - about 1 set in 10. Do not mark "none of the statements" unless you can disprove each one.
- **3 statements: "two of three true" is the commonest key** in APPSC; **4 statements: other exams favour "three of four"**.
- **2 statements:** exactly one true and both true are near even - judge each; "neither" is the outsider.

5. Keywords inside a statement - how often such a statement is TRUE

From every statement whose truth the key settles (statement sets, "which statement is correct / NOT correct", "which pair is correctly matched"). Baseline: any statement is true APPSC 55%, others 51%.

Statement contains	APPSC true	Other exams true	Verdict
exclusively / solely / entirely	0% (0/4)	14% (1/7)	leans **FALSE**
any	20% (2/10)	42% (15/36)	leans **FALSE**
cannot / can not	50% (2/4)	33% (4/12)	leans **FALSE**
not	46% (16/35)	36% (45/124)	leans **FALSE**
all	45% (9/20)	39% (28/71)	leans **FALSE**
only	54% (13/24)	40% (27/68)	no signal
recently / launched	38% (3/8)	47% (21/45)	no signal
must	33% (1/3)	50% (5/10)	no signal
every	50% (1/2)	53% (9/17)	no signal
Article / Section	52% (11/21)	53% (32/60)	no signal
may / can	53% (24/45)	54% (53/99)	no signal
a number (figure, year, %)	56% (78/140)	60% (231/386)	no signal
largest / highest / most	73% (8/11)	58% (38/65)	no signal
first	78% (14/18)	63% (39/62)	leans **TRUE**
Andhra / AP	76% (32/42)	71% (10/14)	leans **TRUE**

- **"exclusively / solely / entirely / completely" - almost always FALSE.** Absolute words that close every exception are the examiner's favourite way to falsify a true fact.
- **"any", "not", "cannot" and "all" inside a statement lean false** (true only 1 time in 3 to 2 in 5).
- **"first" and Andhra-specific statements lean true** (about 3 in 4); "largest / highest / most" mildly so - APPSC writes its true statements about AP and its "firsts" straight from the textbook.
- **"only" is NOT a reliable giveaway in APPSC** - it is true about as often as any statement (UPSC folklore says otherwise). Don't strike an option just for saying "only"; check the fact.
- "may / can" (hedged) statements are near the baseline - no edge.

6. Assertion-Reason and Match-the-following

	Both true, R explains	Both true, R doesn't explain	A true, R false	A false, R true	Both false	count
APPSC	52%	27%	17%	4%	0%	48
Other exams	41%	15%	28%	15%	0%	314

- **Assertion-Reason: "both true and R explains A" is the key about 4 times in 10** - **strong** in both columns. "A false, R true" is the rarest (APPSC 4%). Method: decide A alone, then R alone; only if both are true ask "does R answer *why* A?" - if you can put "because" between them, take option 1.

Match the following (4 pairs)

- APPSC prints few code-style match questions (21 with readable codes) - too few for a probability. What does hold: **you never need all four pairs**. Fix the one pair you are surest of; usually only one or two codes keep it. Then check one more pair.
- **The "consensus" code** (the one agreeing most with the other three codes, pair by pair) was keyed 6 of 9 times in APPSC but only 7 of 23 in other exams - **not reliable**.
- **The straight code A-1, B-2, C-3, D-4** was keyed 5/9 in APPSC, 0/6 elsewhere - examiners do use it, so do not strike it for "looking too easy".
- In APPSC the commoner match form is **"Which pair is correctly / INCORRECTLY matched?"** with four pairs as options - treat it as four true/false statements; in INCORRECT form remember option 4 is keyed most.

7. Subject by subject

History & Culture - 1151 keyed APPSC questions

Shapes: one-liner 93%, statements 2%, match 1%, sequence 1%, statement options 1%. **NOT-type:** 3%. **Key position:** 1 25%, 2 28%, 3 24%, 4 22%. **Option habits:** 'None of the above' keyed 0/16; 'Both' keyed 3/8; longest option keyed 31%.

Most-asked units

1. Indian War of Independence 1857; Religious and Social Reform Movements of the 19th Century; India's Freedom Movement; Revolutionaries in India and Abroad **(236)**
2. Mahatma Gandhi - Thoughts, Principles, Philosophy and Satyagrahas; Sardar Patel and Subhas Chandra Bose; Dr. B.R. Ambedkar; India after Independence and Reorganisation of States **(227)**
3. Indus Valley Civilization, Vedic Age, Mahajanapadas, Jainism & Buddhism, Magadha, Mauryas, Foreign Invasions, Kushanas, Satavahanas, Sangam Age, Sungas, Gupta Empire **(207)**
4. Kanauj and their Contributions; South Indian Dynasties - Badami Chalukyas, Eastern Chalukyas, Rashtrakutas, Kalyani Chalukyas, Cholas, Hoysalas, Yadavas, Kakatiyas, Reddis **(199)**
5. Delhi Sultanate, Vijayanagara Empire, Mughal Empire, Bhakti Movement and Sufism - Administration, Economy, Society, Religion, Literature, Arts and Architecture **(195)**
6. European Trading Companies in India - Struggle for Supremacy (Bengal, Bombay, Madras, Mysore, Andhra, Nizam); Governors-General and Viceroys **(87)**

Most-asked topics

1. Linguistic reorganisation demand; Potti Sriramulu's fast and the formation of Andhra State 1953 **(47)**
2. Social and religious reform in Andhra - Kandukuri Veeresalingam, Gurajada Apparao, Raghupathi Venkataratnam Naidu **(45)**
3. Formation of Andhra Pradesh 1956 - Visalandhra, Gentlemen's Agreement **(42)**
4. Foundation of Vijayanagara - Harihara and Bukka, Vidyaranya; the Sangama dynasty **(39)**
5. Telugu language and literature to the 14th century - Nannaya, Tikkana, Errana, Palkuriki Somanatha **(32)**
6. Satavahanas - origin debate, Simuka, Gautamiputra Satakarni, Nasik Prasasti, Vasishthiputra Pulumavi **(29)**
7. Andhra in the freedom movement - Alluri Sitarama Raju and the Rampa Rebellion, Duggirala Gopalakrishnayya **(29)**
8. Reddi kingdoms of Addanki, Kondavidu and Rajahmundry - Prolaya Vema Reddi, Kumaragiri Reddi **(28)**
9. Eastern Chalukyas of Vengi - Kubja Vishnuvardhana, dynastic history, patronage of Telugu (Nannaya) **(26)**
10. Satavahana administration, economy, coinage and Prakrit literature (Hala's Gathasaptasati) **(23)**
11. Later reorganisation of states - 1960s to 2000; creation of Telangana 2014 **(23)**
12. Swadeshi and Vandemataram movement in Andhra - Bipin Chandra Pal's tour, student participation **(20)**

Polity, Governance & Society - 415 keyed APPSC questions

Shapes: one-liner 81%, statements 9%, statement options 5%, how many 2%, assertion 2%. **NOT-type:** 15%. **Key position:** 1 31%, 2 28%, 3 21%, 4 20%. **Option habits:** 'None of the above' keyed 1/7; 'Both' keyed 15/22; longest option keyed 30%.

Most-asked units

1. Functions and Responsibilities of the Union and States; Parliament and State Legislatures; Federal Structure, Devolution of Powers and Finances up to Local Levels **(137)**
2. Constitutional Authorities - Powers, Functions and Responsibilities; Panchayati Raj; Public Policy and Governance **(84)**
3. Indian Constitution - Evolution, Features, Preamble, Fundamental Rights, Fundamental Duties, DPSP, Amendments, Significant Provisions and Basic Structure **(67)**
4. India's Foreign Policy and International Relations; Important Institutions, Agencies and Fora; Important Policies and Programmes of Central and State Governments **(60)**
5. Rights Issues - Human Rights, Women's Rights, SC/ST Rights, Child Rights **(50)**
6. Impact of Liberalization, Privatization and Globalization on Governance; Statutory, Regulatory and Quasi-Judicial Bodies **(17)**

Most-asked topics

1. Important policies and programmes of the Government of Andhra Pradesh - welfare and social security **(18)**
2. High Courts and subordinate judiciary; judicial review, judicial activism, PIL and judicial overreach debate **(14)**
3. Vice-President; Prime Minister and the Union Council of Ministers - Articles 74, 75, 77, 78 **(13)**
4. Parliament - composition of Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha, qualifications, terms, special powers of Rajya Sabha **(11)**
5. Women's welfare schemes - Beti Bachao Beti Padhao, Mission Shakti, PMMVY, Ujjwala **(11)**
6. Federal structure of India - features of federalism and unitary bias; Seventh Schedule (three lists), residuary powers **(10)**
7. Child welfare - ICDS, POSHAN Abhiyaan, mid-day meal (PM POSHAN), child marriage, malnutrition **(9)**
8. Governor - appointment, powers, discretionary powers, position and controversies (Article 200/201, Article 356 reports) **(9)**
9. Budget in Parliament - stages, cut motions, appropriation and finance bills, Consolidated/Contingency/Public Account **(8)**
10. Sources of the Indian Constitution - borrowed features and their origin countries **(8)**
11. Supreme Court - composition, appointment, collegium and NJAC, jurisdictions (original, appellate, advisory, writ) **(8)**
12. State legislature - Assembly and Legislative Council; creation and abolition of the Council (Article 169) **(8)**

Economy (India & AP) - 494 keyed APPSC questions

Shapes: one-liner 87%, how many 4%, statement options 3%, statements 3%, assertion 2%. **NOT-type:** 9%. **Key position:** 1 29%, 2 26%, 3 25%, 4 21%. **Option habits:** 'None of the above' keyed 1/11; 'Both' keyed 13/17; longest option keyed 32%.

Most-asked units

1. Andhra Pradesh Economy after Bifurcation (2014) AND the A.P. Reorganisation Act, 2014 - Economic Issues, Central Assistance, Special Status and the Controversy **(147)**
2. Indian Agriculture, Irrigation, Inputs, Policy, Land Reforms, Credit, MSP, Food Security; Indian Industry, Industrial Policy, Make in India, SEZs, Energy; Economic Reforms; International Trade, BoP and WTO **(96)**

Most-asked topics

1. Approaches and initiatives in AP industry - industrial policy, single desk, MSMEs, industrial nodes **(18)**
2. Poverty eradication and livelihood programmes - DAY-NRLM, DAY-NULM, SHG movement **(16)**
3. Basic features of the Andhra Pradesh economy after bifurcation - GSDP, growth rate, sectoral shares **(16)**

3. Basic Characteristics of the Indian Economy; Planning since Independence; NITI Aayog; Growth and Distributive Justice; HDI; Environmental Degradation; Sustainable Development **(92)**
4. Financial Institutions, RBI and Monetary Policy, Banking Reforms, NPAs, Financial Markets, SEBI, Indian Tax System, GST, Centre-State Financial Relations, Public Debt and Expenditure, Fiscal Policy and Budget **(83)**
5. National Income and its Concepts; India's National Accounts; Demographic Issues; Poverty and Inequalities; Occupational Structure and Unemployment; Employment and Poverty Eradication Schemes; Rural and Urban Development **(76)**

4. Approaches and initiatives in AP agriculture - APCNF/ZBNF, horticulture, aquaculture, allied sectors **(16)**
5. NITI Aayog initiatives - SDG India Index, Aspirational Districts Programme, Health/Education indices, Atal Innovation Mission **(16)**
6. A.P. Reorganisation Act 2014 - structure, schedules and key provisions **(14)**
7. Five Year Plans I to XII - objectives, targets, achievements and failures of each **(13)**
8. National income concepts - GDP, GNP, NDP, NNP, factor cost vs market price, GVA, deflator **(10)**
9. Banking in India - nationalisation, structure, priority sector, small finance and payments banks **(9)**
10. AP state finances - revenue receipts and expenditure, debt and interest payments, latest AP Budget **(9)**
11. Economic growth vs economic development; measures of development **(9)**
12. Social welfare programmes in AP - SC/ST/BC/minority welfare, pensions, housing, women and child welfare **(8)**

Geography (India, World & AP) - 613 keyed APPSC questions

Shapes: one-liner 88%, statements 3%, statement options 3%, assertion 2%, match 2%. **NOT-type:** 10%. **Key position:** 1 28%, 2 25%, 3 26%, 4 21%. **Option habits:** 'Both' keyed 9/17; longest option keyed 29%.

Most-asked units

1. Physical Geography of the World, India and Andhra Pradesh - Physical Divisions, Earthquakes, Landslides, Drainage, Climate and Monsoon, Vegetation, Parks and Sanctuaries, Soils, Rocks and Minerals **(280)**
2. General Geography - Earth in the Solar System, Motions, Time, Seasons, Interior of the Earth, Landforms, Atmosphere, Climate, Oceans, Hydrological Disasters, Marine and Continental Resources **(195)**
3. Economic Geography of the World, India and Andhra Pradesh - Major Sectors, Agriculture, Industry and Services, Basic Industries, Transport and Trade **(90)**
4. Social Geography of the World, India and Andhra Pradesh - Distribution, Density, Growth, Sex Ratio, Literacy, Occupational Structure, SC/ST Population, Rural-Urban Components, Racial/Tribal/Religious/Linguistic Groups, Urbanisation, Migration and Metropolitan Regions **(48)**

Most-asked topics

1. Disaster management framework - hazard vs disaster, DM Act 2005, NDMA, early warning systems **(57)**
2. Andhra Pradesh - drainage: Godavari, Krishna, Penna, Vamsadhara, Nagavali; reservoirs and canals **(27)**
3. Andhra Pradesh - soil types and their distribution **(25)**
4. India - rocks and mineral belts; distribution of metallic and non-metallic minerals **(24)**
5. World - major rivers, lakes, seas, straits, canals and islands **(22)**
6. India - Peninsular drainage: east-flowing and west-flowing rivers, river basins, watershed **(22)**
7. India - the Northern Plains, the Peninsular Plateau, the Coastal Plains and the Islands **(20)**
8. Earthquakes - causes, seismic waves, measurement, distribution, effects **(18)**
9. Hydrological disasters - floods, flash floods, cloudbursts, droughts, tsunamis, storm surges **(18)**
10. The universe and the solar system - origin theories, the Sun, planets, asteroids, comets, meteors **(16)**
11. Atmospheric disturbances - tropical cyclones, temperate cyclones, anticyclones, thunderstorms, tornadoes **(16)**

12. Transport in Andhra Pradesh - highways, railway network, ports (Visakhapatnam, Krishnapatnam, Gangavaram, Kakinada), airports **(15)**

Science, Technology & Environment - 441 keyed APPSC questions

Shapes: one-liner 84%, statements 5%, assertion 5%, statement options 3%, how many 2%. **NOT-type:** 10%. **Key position:** 1 29%, 2 27%, 3 23%, 4 21%. **Option habits:** 'None of the above' keyed 1/4; 'Both' keyed 18/31; longest option keyed 30%.

Most-asked units

1. Environmental Science - Issues and Concerns, Legal Aspects and Treaties, Biodiversity, Climate Change, Forest and Wildlife, Pollution, Disaster Management, Biotechnology and Nanotechnology, Genetic Engineering, Health and Environment **(232)**
2. Science and Technology - Nature and Scope, Relevance to Daily Life, National S&T Policy, Institutions and Prominent Indian Scientists **(79)**
3. Technology in Space and Defence - Indian Space Programme, ISRO, Satellite Programmes, IRNSS, IRS, Defence and Academic Satellites, DRDO **(60)**
4. Information and Communication Technology - Nature and Scope, ICT in Daily Life, ICT and Industry, ICT and Governance, Netiquettes, Cyber Security **(36)**
5. Energy Requirement and Efficiency - India's Energy Needs and Deficit, Energy Resources and Dependence, Energy Policy, Government Policies and Programmes, Solar, Wind and Nuclear Energy **(34)**

Most-asked topics

1. Relevance of science and technology to day-to-day life - health, food, transport, communication, household **(49)**
2. Goals of sustainable development - the 17 SDGs, targets and India's SDG Index performance **(24)**
3. Environmental hazards and disaster management - DM Act 2005, NDMA and NDRF, Sendai Framework, disaster types and mitigation **(18)**
4. Health and environment - vector-borne and water-borne diseases, air pollution and health, antimicrobial resistance, One Health **(14)**
5. Environment - components; ecology, ecosystem, food chain and food web, energy flow, ecological pyramids **(12)**
6. Solid waste, plastic waste, e-waste, biomedical and construction waste - rules and management **(12)**
7. Applications of space technology - agriculture, disaster management, telemedicine, tele-education, navigation **(11)**
8. Earth observation - IRS series, Cartosat, Resourcesat, Oceansat, RISAT, EOS series and applications **(11)**
9. International environmental treaties - Stockholm 1972, Rio 1992, Ramsar, CITES, CBD and its protocols **(10)**
10. Climate change - greenhouse effect, greenhouse gases, radiative forcing, evidence and observed impacts **(9)**
11. Sustainable development - meaning, nature, scope and components **(9)**
12. Environmental legislation in India - Water Act 1974, Air Act 1981, Environment (Protection) Act 1986 **(9)**

Current Affairs - 86 keyed APPSC questions

Shapes: one-liner 91%, statements 3%, how many 3%, pairs 1%, sequence 1%. **NOT-type:** 6%. **Key position:** 1 29%, 2 34%, 3 21%, 4 16%. **Option habits:** 'None of the above' keyed 0/1; 'Both' keyed 0/2; longest option keyed 19%.

Most-asked units

1. Sports - major tournaments, winners, records and hosting rights **(10)**
2. Awards and honours - national civilian awards, international prizes, film and literary awards **(10)**

Most-asked topics

1. Special topics: Awards and honours - national civilian awards, international prizes, film and literary awards **(6)**
2. Overview and data: International - summits, conferences and their outcomes **(4)**

3. National - new central schemes, missions and their features **(9)**
4. International - bilateral visits, defence deals and geopolitical developments **(8)**
5. International - summits, conferences and their outcomes **(7)**
6. Science and technology in news - space missions, defence tests, health and biotech developments **(6)**
7. Books and authors; important days and their themes **(6)**
8. Reports and indices - releasing agency, India's rank, key findings **(6)**

3. Sep–Oct 2026: National - new central schemes, missions and their features **(4)**
4. Jun–Aug 2026: International - bilateral visits, defence deals and geopolitical developments **(4)**
5. Jun–Aug 2026: Sports - major tournaments, winners, records and hosting rights **(3)**
6. Apr–Nov 2025: Science and technology in news - space missions, defence tests, health and biotech developments **(3)**
7. Mar–May 2026: National - new central schemes, missions and their features **(3)**
8. Jun–Aug 2026: Books and authors; important days and their themes **(3)**
9. Mar–May 2026: Andhra Pradesh - projects, investments, MoUs, industrial and infrastructure developments **(2)**
10. Mar–May 2026: International - bilateral visits, defence deals and geopolitical developments **(2)**
11. Overview and data: Sports - major tournaments, winners, records and hosting rights **(2)**
12. Mar–May 2026: Sports - major tournaments, winners, records and hosting rights **(2)**

8. Topic by topic - how APPSC sets each high-yield topic

The 15 topics per subject with the most APPSC questions, with what the examiner keeps asking there.

History & Culture

Linguistic reorganisation demand; Potti Sriramulu's fast and the formation of Andhra State 1953 (52 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks single facts: capital of Andhra State 1953 (Kurnool, asked 3+ times), date of Sriramulu's death (15 Dec 1952), who ended Sitaram's fast (Vinoba Bhave), Partition Committee chair (Kumaraswamy Raja).
- Recurring persons/places: Bapatla 1913 president B.N. Sarma who opposed separation; Cooum boundary = Raja of Panagal; Sri Bagh 1937 = Andhra-Rayalaseema; Justice Party govt -> Andhra University.
- Shapes used: session -> president match lists, chronological ordering (Dhar -> Visalandhra -> Sitaram fast -> SRC), first office holders (Speaker Nallapati Venkatramaiah, budget 1955-56 B. Gopala Reddy).
- Traps: Sri Bagh (1937) vs Gentlemen's Agreement (1956); Andhra State 1 Oct 1953 vs AP 1 Nov 1956; Dar (Constituent Assembly) vs JVP (Congress).

Social and religious reform in Andhra - Kandukuri Veeresalingam, Gurajada Apparao, Raghupathi Venkataratnam Naidu (48 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC overwhelmingly asks Veeresalingam one-liners: Vivekavardhini (1874) founder/year, Satihita Bodhini for women, Hitakarini Samaj, first girls' school, Rajasekhara Charitra = first Telugu novel, 'father of Telugu renaissance'.
- Other recurring APPSC facts: Bhogam abolition = Raghupathi Venkataratnam Naidu; Kanyasulkam = Gurajada; Prakasika (1896) = Gurajada; Vyavaharika Samaj = Gidugu; Kasiyatra Charitra = Enugula Veeraswamayya.
- Shapes are direct 'who founded/wrote' and simple correct-pair questions; traps swap journals among Veeresalingam, Kokkonda and Venkataratnam Naidu.
- Watch conflicting keys: G2 2025 Vivekavardhini (D. Rangacharyulu), Brahmo Samaj in combined AP keyed to Veeresalingam.

Formation of Andhra Pradesh 1956 - Visalandhra, Gentlemen's Agreement (48 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks single facts: who was not a Gentlemen's Agreement signatory (Prakasam), name of the 1956 agreement, first CM (Sanjiva Reddy), first capital.
- Visalandhra Mahasabha details recur: founded Nov 1949 at Vijayawada by Ayyadevara Kaleswara Rao, first meeting Warangal 1950; 'Communists opposed linguistic states' is the planted false statement.
- CM chronology and tenure items are frequent (Sanjivayya 1960-62, Brahmananda Reddy 1964-71, Nadendla 31 days, Panchayat Raj under Sanjiva Reddy).
- Telangana-movement leaders (TPS founder Chenna Reddy, CM during 1969 = Brahmananda Reddy, Ramananda Tirtha) are filed here too.

Foundation of Vijayanagara - Harihara and Bukka, Vidyaranya; the Sangama dynasty (41 APPSC Qs)

- Bulk of PYQs are one-liners: founders Harihara and Bukka (1336), Tungabhadra dam = Devaraya I, Abdur Razzaq = Devaraya II, embassy to China = Bukka I.
- APPSC-specific: founders as Kakatiya officials (Warangal link), Raichur Doab as main cause of wars, Devaraya II's literary hall Mutyalasala, 'odd one out' dynasties.
- Dynasty order Sangama-Saluva-Tuluva-Aravidu and the usurpations (Saluva Narasimha, Vira Narasimha) are a frequent statement item.
- Literary sources (Madhura Vijayam by Gangadevi, Sayana's Vedic commentaries, Sewell's A Forgotten Empire) recur.

Telugu language and literature to the 14th century - Nannaya, Tikkana, Errana, Palkuriki Somanatha (32 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks author-work one-liners: Pavuluri Mallana = Ganita Sara Sangraha, Ketana = Abhinava Dandi (Dasakumara Charitra), Jayapa = Gaja-Sahini, Nannechoda = Kumarasambhavam.
- Statement-type items on Nannaya (Andhra Mahabharatam, Andhra Shabda Chintamani, Nandampudi agrahara) with keys sometimes differing from textbook versions.
- Not-correctly-matched pairs among Shiva Kavis (Palkuriki - Panditaradhya Charitra / Basava Puranam) are a recurring trap.
- UPSC/other PSC items cover epic versions in other languages (Pampa - Kannada); APPSC stays on Telugu poets and Kakatiya-court authors.

Andhra in the freedom movement - Alluri Sitarama Raju and the Rampa Rebellion, Duggirala Gopalakrishnayya (32 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks this topic almost entirely as direct single facts: Alluri's tomb (Krishnadevipeta), first PS attacked (Chintapalli), rebellion years (1922-24), Madras Forest Act (1882).
- Duggirala angles recur: leader of Chirala-Perala, Ramadandu volunteer corps (distractor Shanti Sena), title Andhra Ratna.
- Match-the-following of Andhra leaders -> movement/title/book (Veeraiah Chowdary-Pedanandipadu, Kaleswara Rao-Naa Jeevitha Katha, Tripuraneni-Kavi Raju).
- Trap: 'Andhra Shivaji' (Veeraiah Chowdary) vs 'Andhra Ratna' (Duggirala); Hyderabad State Congress 1938.

Satavahanas - origin debate, Simuka, Gautamiputra Satakarni, Nasik Prasasti, Vasishthiputra Pulumavi (30 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks single facts: first dynasty of Andhra = Satavahanas, earliest inscriptions in Maharashtra, Anupa capital = Mahishmati.
- Queens recur: Devi Naganika as regent (distractors Gautami Balasri, Lilavati); Nasik Prasasti by Gautami Balasri.
- Scholar-theory matching on origin (Sukthankar, Bhandarkar) and 'which work does NOT narrate early history' (Gathasaptasati) are APPSC favourites.
- First land grants to Brahmanas/Buddhists = Satavahanas; Matsya Purana has the longest king list.

Reddi kingdoms of Addanki, Kondavidu and Rajahmundry - Prolaya Vema Reddi, Kumaragiri Reddi (30 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks one-fact items on Reddi culture: Puriti Pannu (Racha Vema), Sangeeta Chintamani (Pedakomati), Haravilasam (sea trade), Surambika's tank, Ghatika Yantra, Srinatha's works.
- Chronological ordering of rulers (Anavota -> Anavema -> Kumaragiri -> Pedakomati) is a recurring G2 shape.
- Key slips exist (Puriti Pannu keyed to Kataya Vema; tank name differs across years) - read options carefully.

Eastern Chalukyas of Vengi - Kubja Vishnuvardhana, dynastic history, patronage of Telugu (Nannaya) (29 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks title-to-ruler single facts: Tripura-Martya-Maheswara = Gunaga Vijayaditya; 108 Saiva temples; Kandukuru developed as Bezawada = Vijayaditya III.
- Chola-Vengi matrimonial ties are a recurring stem (Cholas' close relations with the Chalukyas of Vengi).
- Jain patronage by queens (Ayyana Mahadevi, Nedumba Vasati) and inscriptions (Bezwada 885 CE) are asked at G1/G2 level.
- Keys in this topic are often shaky (Vijayaditya I vs II, Ayyana Mahadevi's husband) - stick to standard history.

Later reorganisation of states - 1960s to 2000; creation of Telangana 2014 (24 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks APRA 2014 as pure number/structure recall: 12 Parts, 108 Sections, 13 Schedules; 'which Part deals with X' (Part V revenue, Part VIII services, Part XII amends Arts 371D/168); Section 8 Governor and common capital; appointed day 2 June 2014.
- Mulki/regional-agitation questions are cause-effect one-steppers: Jai Andhra caused by the SC Mulki judgment; ended by the Six-Point Formula; President's Rule 1973 due to Jai Andhra; Six-Point given effect by the 32nd Amendment (traps: 33rd, 'abolition of Mulki rules', 'repression').
- State-formation items are chronological-order or year-matching (Haryana 1966 -> Meghalaya/Tripura 1972 -> Karnataka rename 1973; J&K/Ladakh UTs 2019); APPSC does not go into Acts' clause details.

Satavahana administration, economy, coinage and Prakrit literature (Hala's Gathasaptasati) (23 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks single facts: Katantra = Sarvavarma, guild interest 12%, Kolika = weavers, ship coins = Yajna Sri, metals used (no nickel/gold), official language Prakrit.
- APPSC Group-1 term items: 'Katakas and Skandhavaras' = military camps serving as administrative centres; Gulmika; Nigama Sabha.
- APPSC Group-2 2025 uses statement/A-R pairs: Roman trade declined post-Satavahana (A false, R true); Gathasaptasati love themes true, Brihatkatha in Sanskrit false.
- Traps: Brihatkatha language Paishachi not Sanskrit; Gathasaptasati not a political-history source; iron-copper coated coins belong to a later Andhra dynasty.

Swadeshi and Vandemataram movement in Andhra - Bipin Chandra Pal's tour, student participation (22 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks direct identification items: Swadeshi in Andhra = Vandemataram Movement; Rajahmundry College incident (1907) = start of student participation.
- Event-year statement items recur: Pal's tour 1907, Tenali bomb 1909, AICC at Bezawada (1921, trap 1919).
- Person-attribution items on Chilakamarti (Ram Mohan school, Desamata) and Japan-victory literature.

Vijayanagara society, economy and trade; accounts of Nicolo Conti, Abdur Razzak, Domingo Paes, Nuniz (17 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC pairs a traveller with one fact: 300 ports (Abdur Razzak in the Group-2 key), traveller-ruler pairs (Nuniz-Achyuta, Razzak-Devaraya II).
- Andhra-centred society/economy terms recur: Vipravinodins = Brahmin jugglers for Brahmins; Porumamilla = 12 tank rules; Vasavi seat = Penugonda.
- Distractor sets reuse other Andhra inscriptions (Tummalagudem, Korlagallu, Bitragunta).
- Traps: Penugonda (W. Godavari) vs Penukonda; Conti is Italian, Nuniz Portuguese.

Saluva and Tuluva dynasties; Krishnadevaraya - conquests, Amuktamalyada, the Ashtadiggajas (16 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC Group-2 asks AP-centred one-liners: victory pillar location (Potnuru), Pedaganjam/Chinaganjam = salt, Jambavati Kalyanam = Sanskrit.
- Foreign accounts: Domingo Paes described the House of Victory; Nuniz came under Achyutaraya - standard trap.
- Amuktamalyada 'which is not described' (his invasions) and Ashtadiggaja poet-work-title matching (Peddana = Andhra Kavita Pitamaha).
- Usurpation founders: Tuluva founder = Vira Narasimha; Annamacharya contemporary of Saluva Narasimha.

Kakatiya art - Thousand Pillar Temple, Ramappa/Rudreshwara (UNESCO 2021), Warangal Fort (15 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC keeps returning to Jayapa Senani's Nritta Ratnavali: the basis of the Ramappa dance sculptures, and the ruler he served (Ganapatideva).
- Inscription-to-fact items: Jalakaranda in the Dharmasagara inscription.
- Statement sets on Kakatiya architecture: Jain phase, Chalukyan influence, Thousand Pillar trikuta (Rudreshwara, Vasudeva, Surya).

Polity, Governance & Society

Important policies and programmes of the Government of Andhra Pradesh - welfare and social security (22 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks scheme-to-purpose and scheme-to-amount one-liners: Amma Vodi/Talliki Vandanam Rs 15,000 to mothers, Rythu Bharosa Rs 13,500 incl. Rs 6,000 PM-KISAN, Cheyutha Rs 75,000 over 4 years for women 45-60, Aasara = SHG loans outstanding on 11 April 2019.
- Launch dates are asked directly (Rythu Bharosa Oct 2019, Jagananna houses 3 June 2021, P4 on Ugadi 30 March 2025); pension step-ups (Rs 2,250 to Rs 2,500, Jan 2022).
- 'Which is NOT part of Navaratnalu' and old-name/new-name pairs are recurring traps; NTR Vaidya Seva Rs 25 lakh cover (May 2025) keyed.

High Courts and subordinate judiciary; judicial review, judicial activism, PIL and judicial overreach debate (18 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks direct facts: judicial review borrowed from USA, judicial activism originated in USA, PIL = Social Action Litigation pioneered by Krishna Iyer and Bhagwati, 224A consent of the President.
- Strong AP angle: separate AP High Court functioning at Amaravati from 1 Jan 2019, first (acting) CJ C. Praveen Kumar at Vijayawada, AP Reorganisation Act Sec. 30/31/32 match.
- APPSC also asks current-affairs court news (HC orders on AP districts/Amaravati, new SC judges, pendency 4.7 crore / 87% subordinate) and 'not an SC evolution' (exemptions to FRs).
- Other PSCs favour: retirement 62, resignation to President, President fixes HC strength, court of record (129/215), district judge (Art. 233/236), H.N. Sanyal Committee, PIL in SC and HC.

Vice-President; Prime Minister and the Union Council of Ministers - Articles 74, 75, 77, 78 (15 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks direct single-fact items: who elects the VP (both Houses), removal resolution first in Rajya Sabha (Art. 67), President resigns to VP, PM appointed by President, PM chairs Planning Commission/NITI.
- Size cap is a favourite: 91st Amdt, 15% of Lok Sabha (Union) and 15% / minimum 12 (States) - other PSCs repeat this almost verbatim.
- APPSC Group-1 uses 'choose the WRONG statement' on CoM (trap: President gets discretion in National Emergency) and constitutional equality of ministers.
- Records/firsts (first VP, diplomat VPs, PM succession order) and current incumbents appear as one-liners.

Federal structure of India - features of federalism and unitary bias; Seventh Schedule (three lists), residuary powers (13 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC repeatedly asks 'who called India quasi-federal' (K.C. Wheare), 'federation with a centralising tendency' (Jennings), 'elephantine size' (H.V. Kamath).
- APPSC 'NOT a federal feature' items: Office of the Governor, CAG, 'allocation of financial resources'; Union of India = indissoluble union of States; First Schedule lists territories.
- List questions are single-subject: Banking -> Union, Forests -> Concurrent, Higher education not in State List, Entry 64 = institutions of national importance.
- Other PSCs favour Railway Police -> State, Economic planning -> Concurrent, Panchayati Raj -> State, Art. 249 Rajya Sabha 2/3 present and voting, 42nd Amendment education transfer.

Parliament - composition of Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha, qualifications, terms, special powers of Rajya Sabha (12 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks bare numbers: LS max 550 / present 543, RS 250 / 12 nominated, AP RS seats 11 (undivided 18), women in 2009 LS = 59, quorum one-tenth.
- Statement-type items test traps: RS not dissolved and 1/3 retire every two years, nominated fields exclude sport, no educational qualification, Anglo-Indian nomination ended by 104th Amdt.
- Rajya Sabha special/equal powers recur: Art. 249 authorises Parliament (not State Assemblies), equal status = CAG report + emergency approval, not money bills or VP removal.
- Privileges asked via 'which is correct' with civil-only freedom from arrest and both collective and individual privileges.

Governor - appointment, powers, discretionary powers, position and controversies (Article 200/201, Article 356 reports) (12 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks single-fact article numbers: Art. 153 (one Governor for 2+ States, 7th Amendment), 155 appointment, 164 CM appointment, 213 ordinance, 356 PR.
- Statement-type traps: 'Governor quits immediately after term' (false), minimum age 35, max PR 3 years, never in Telangana/Chhattisgarh, reservation = central control.
- AP angle: number of PR spells in AP (1973 Jai Andhra; Andhra State 1954-55), first Governor C.M. Trivedi.
- Other PSCs favour discretion lists (UPSC 2014: report under 356 + reservation of bills), immunity under Art. 361, ordinance approved by State Legislature.

Women's welfare schemes - Beti Bachao Beti Padhao, Mission Shakti, PMMVY, Ujjwala (12 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks direct one-liners: Ujjwala is meant for women / its objective is free LPG to BPL women; RMK set up 1993; Stand-Up India for greenfield enterprises.
- Count/structure questions: MWCD schemes grouped under three umbrella missions; Mahila e-Haat = MWCD web marketing platform.
- 'Which is NOT correct' items on girl-child schemes (BBBP, Sukanya, Balika Samriddhi) and flagship-programme lists recur.

Child welfare - ICDS, POSHAN Abhiyaan, mid-day meal (PM POSHAN), child marriage, malnutrition (12 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC repeats ICDS functionary questions: Anganwadi Worker as grass-root ICDS functionary; NIPCCD trains CDPOs
- Direct one-liners on launch facts: POSHAN Abhiyaan 2018, Mid-Day Meal 1995, Poshan Bhi Padhai Bhi launched by WCD Minister (May 2023)
- Scheme-identification items: Mission Vatsalya (child protection + SDGs), ALIVA (Nayagarh, Odisha), Akshaya Patra (largest MDM NGO), Vatsalya budget 2021-22
- Traps: ICDS vs NHM/ANM; PM POSHAN (Education) vs Poshan 2.0 (MWCD); Ujjawala vs Ujjwala

State legislature - Assembly and Legislative Council; creation and abolition of the Council (Article 169) (10 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks direct single-fact items: which states have Councils, Council composition fractions (EXCEPT form), officers of Assembly, Article range 168-212
- Recurring traps: 1/3-1/12-1/12-1/3-1/6 shares, Speaker resigns to Deputy Speaker, Speaker does not preside during own removal, Council only delays (no joint sitting)
- AP tilt: AP Reorganisation Act 2014 caps AP Council at 50; AP Council abolished 1985, revived 2007
- Art. 169 process: Assembly special majority, Parliament simple majority, not an Art. 368 amendment

Supreme Court - composition, appointment, collegium and NJAC, jurisdictions (original, appellate, advisory, writ) (10 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks single facts: Parliament increases number of judges, first CJI H.J. Kania, 99th Amendment void in 2015, Chelameswar upheld NJAC, Art. 128 retired judges need CJI + President's consent.
- Other PSCs/UPSC repeat: Centre-State disputes = original jurisdiction (Art. 131), Art. 143 advisory, Art. 137 review, Art. 142 complete justice / curative petition, minimum 5 judges for constitutional questions.
- Removal traps: special majority in each House, Judges (Inquiry) Act 1968 (100 LS / 50 RS), Speaker can refuse motion, no judge removed; Soumitra Sen resigned in 2011.
- Appointments: ad hoc judges only in SC for quorum, no additional judges in SC, resignation to President, 10 years HC advocate.

73rd Amendment - Part IX, Eleventh Schedule, three-tier structure, Gram Sabha, reservations, State Election Commission (9 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC uses 'which is/are NOT correct' statement sets on 73rd provisions: 18 items is false (29 in Eleventh Schedule), BC reservation voluntary, exemptions Nagaland/Meghalaya/Mizoram, court bar in electoral matters.
- APPSC tests Gram Sabha = all registered voters, Gram Sabha as direct democracy, elections within six months, minimum age 21, 1/3 women.
- State Finance Commission recurs in APPSC G1/G2 (every 5 years, taxes/tolls/fees, reviews State-local revenue distribution); Union FC role via Art. 280(3)(bb).
- Eleventh vs Twelfth Schedule item traps (slaughterhouses, burial grounds, cattle pounds = Twelfth; land-use regulation APPSC key = Eleventh).

Sources of the Indian Constitution - borrowed features and their origin countries (8 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks one-line 'borrowed from which country' items: concurrent list = Australia, RS election = South Africa, cabinet system/bicameralism/single citizenship = Britain.
- 'Which is NOT correct' list items (amendment from France = wrong; South Africa is right) recur.
- Federal system from GoI Act 1935 is a favourite APPSC Group-2 fact.
- DPSP = Ireland, FRs = USA, federation with strong Centre = Canada dominate other PSCs.

Parts, Schedules and Articles of the Constitution - structural map and the twelve schedules (8 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks one-line locator items: which Article (Art. 1 Union of States, Art. 370), which Part (Part V Union Executive, Part XX amendment), which Schedule (2nd = President's salary).
- Number recall: original 8 Schedules, now 12; 22 Parts originally; Eighth Schedule languages and the amendments adding them (21st Sindhi, 71st Konkani/Manipuri/Nepali, 92nd Bodo/Dogri/Maithili/Santhali).
- AP tilt: Articles 371D/371E (32nd Amendment, 1973) and Article 371 series match questions.

Directive Principles of State Policy - Articles 36-51, classification, implementation (8 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks directive -> Article (Art. 40 village panchayats, Art. 45), 'which is NOT a DPSP' (right to work vs FRs; international trade) and whether 39(b)/(c) texts are in the Constitution.
- Other PSCs repeatedly test: borrowed from Ireland, welfare state in DPSP, social and economic democracy, 42nd Amendment additions (39A, 43A, 48A), environment in both DPSP and FD.
- Traps: Art. 45 now = ECCE below 6 (6-14 moved to 21A); 'cheque payable at bank's convenience' = K.T. Shah.

Parliamentary devices - Question Hour, Zero Hour, motions (adjournment, no-confidence, censure, calling attention) (8 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks direct one-liners: 'most powerful weapon' = no-confidence motion; time after Question Hour without notice = Zero Hour.
- Committees are a big share: largest committee / no RS member = Estimates; CAG reports = PAC; PAC chair nominated by Speaker; CPU is a parliamentary financial committee.
- Numbers recur: 50 members for no-confidence, PAC 22 (15+7), Estimates 30, SC/ST committee 20+10, 2G JPC 30 (20+10, P.C. Chacko).
- Traps: Zero Hour not in Rules; censure needs reasons, no-confidence does not; calling attention restricted adjournment motion.

Economy (India & AP)

Approaches and initiatives in AP industry - industrial policy, single desk, MSMEs, industrial nodes (21 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks direct policy numbers: Single Desk approvals in 21 days, mega status = 2,000 jobs, 16.2% APIIC plots for SC, 33% land for MSMEs, 26 cement plants (2014-15), 4.0 policies = 2024-29.
- Rank questions recur with specific reporting windows (FDI rank 12th/13th/14th, industrial output 7th) - window wording is the trap.
- 'Which is NOT a standard incentive' and 'which statement is incorrect' about the policy text (Foreign vs Fixed capital investment, GSDP share, facilitation timelines).
- Current-affairs company-location items (Pepper Motion-Punganur, Hindalco-Apple, APIIC-Union Bank MoU) appear in G2.

Basic features of the Andhra Pradesh economy after bifurcation - GSDP, growth rate, sectoral shares (20 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks AP economy as single-figure recall tied to a specific Survey/estimate: sector shares of GVA at current prices for a named year (2021-22 services 42%; 2022-23 36.19/23.36/40.45), 'record growth 11.43% in 2021-22', 'first in GSDP growth 2015-16', 'only state with double-digit growth 2015-16'.
- Match-the-following of sector/sub-sector to growth or share (2023-24 AE growth rates; 2024-25 sub-sector GVA shares: communications 2%, construction 8%, horticulture 10%, fishing 9%) is a recurring format; options are permutations of the same numbers.
- Vision documents are asked by target year (Vision 2029: most preferred investment destination by 2050; 2029 targets list) and Swarna Andhra basics (10 Padi Sutralu, P4 aim); not by rupee/dollar milestones.
- Trap is always the estimate stage and price basis: livestock leads at current prices, fishing at constant; AE vs FRE figures differ, so the year+stage must match the key.

Five Year Plans I to XII - objectives, targets, achievements and failures of each (19 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks plan -> theme one-liners: 11th 'faster and more inclusive', 12th 'faster, sustainable and more inclusive', heavy industry = Second, first priority to agriculture = First.
- Dates/periods: Fourth Plan launched 1969, Plan Holiday 1966-69, Rolling Plan 1978-80, Eighth began 1992; highest growth = Eleventh (APPSC), older PSCs keyed Tenth.
- Programme -> plan matching (CDP 1952, JRY Seventh, Women's Component Plan Ninth, RKVY Eleventh, 20-point programme 1975) recurs across PSCs.
- APPSC Group-1 also asks targets/data (11th Plan 9.5% AP target, 2002-03 growth, Second Plan pruning due to forex shortage).

NITI Aayog initiatives - SDG India Index, Aspirational Districts Programme, Health/Education indices, Atal Innovation Mission (17 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks AP's rank in the SDG India Index (overall 4th in 2020-21, SDG-7 1st, SDG-14 2nd, SDG-1 3rd) - straight recall with Roman-numeral or ordinal options.
- Publisher matching recurs: SDG India Index = NITI, Global SDG Report = UNSD, VNR = member states, NIF = MoSPI.
- SDG number-to-name items (SDG 13 climate, SDG 14 oceans, SDG 6 water, SDG 15 life on land) are frequent single-fact questions.
- Current-affairs MoUs/SoIs (NITI-UNICEF children 2022, NITI-UNDP 2023, E-FAST with WRI) and India's SDSN rank by year appear often.

Approaches and initiatives in AP agriculture - APCNF/ZBNF, horticulture, aquaculture, allied sectors (17 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks direct SES-figure items: RBKs 10,778 (SES 2023-24), Rythu Bharosa ₹13,500, egg rank 1st, oil palm output 17.81 lakh t, seafood export share 36%, cropping intensity 1.25, cultivated area 37%.
- Expansion/acronym items recur: RySS = Rythu Sadhikara Samstha, APCNF = Community Managed Natural Farming; Panta Sanjeevani = farm ponds; 'white gold' = cotton.
- Two-statement items on AP ranks (oil palm productivity 1st, mango 2nd) and institute-location items (VBRI Vijayawada, Indo-Israel CoE Palnadu).
- Year-specific SES numbers are the trap: APPSC always ties a figure to a named survey year.

Poverty eradication and livelihood programmes - DAY-NRLM, DAY-NULM, SHG movement (16 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks direct single facts: IRDP start year (1980), NREP/RLEGP in 6th Plan, SGSY launched April 1999 and now 'Aajeevika', NRLM borrowers = women SHGs.
- Strong AP tilt: SAPAP supported by UNDP, IKP full form and merger role, Velugu, MEPMA as urban poverty mission, Abhaya Hastham for SHG women, Janmabhoomi 1997.
- DAY-NULM asked as ministry (Housing and Urban Poverty Alleviation) and current-affairs tie-ups (UNDP-DAY-NULM for women, 2023).
- Other PSCs favour chronology ordering (IRDP-NREP-DWCRA-JRY; IRDP-SGSY-NREGA-PMJDY), odd-one-out (MRTP, NSSF, CRY) and programmes merged into SGSY (JRY not included).

Economic reforms of 1991 - background, stabilisation and structural adjustment measures (15 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks the crisis signature (high inflation, low forex, large fiscal deficit), the 1991 rescue step (IMF loan by pledging gold) and 'what was NOT done' (demonetisation, nationalisation, capital-account convertibility).
- Globalisation-impact trap recurs in APPSC-G2: 'exports grew faster than imports' is the false statement; post-reform shift = enhanced global integration.
- APPSC-G1 asks conceptual one-liners: SAPs reduce fiscal imbalances for long-term growth, jobless growth because reforms were confined to the formal sector, railways not much affected.
- Other PSCs: year of reforms (1991, Rao/Manmohan), Chelliah = tax reforms, post-1991 changes (FDI, forex up; agriculture share not up).

A.P. Reorganisation Act 2014 - structure, schedules and key provisions (14 APPSC Qs)

- Date of President's assent (1 March 2014) is asked repeatedly (5+ APPSC papers); trap options Feb / June 2014 (appointed day 2 June).
- APPSC asks section-number recall: Sec 95 equal higher-education opportunity, Sec 50-51 tax arrears/loans, Sec 26 Assembly 175 -> 225.
- Schedule-content questions: Constitution Schedules amended = First and Fourth; Schedule X lists 107 institutions; VII = list of funds.
- Odd administrative details also asked: judges' salaries split by population ratio, Greyhound centre common for 3 years, 2 advisors to common Governor.

Economic growth vs economic development; measures of development (11 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks concept-identification one-liners: key factor of Western model (economic growth), non-economic factor (corruption), sustainable growth definition, who coined 'Hindu rate of growth' (Raj Krishna).
- Sustainable development / Brundtland definition is the single most repeated item across APPSC papers (G1, 2023 lecturers, screening tests).
- Economist-theory attribution (Nurkse - vicious circle, Sen - capability) and index components (HDI excludes urbanisation; PQLI = IMR + literacy + LE at age one) are the standard traps.
- AP-specific items appear (AP Economic Development Board Act 2018); 'Limits to Growth' asked twice.

National income concepts - GDP, GNP, NDP, NNP, factor cost vs market price, GVA, deflator (11 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks definitional one-liners: NI = NNP at factor cost, per capita income = average income, real GDP = output at base-year prices, GNP deflator ratio.
- Recurring traps: MP vs FC differ by indirect taxes and subsidies (not direct taxes); GDP vs GNP differ by net factor income from abroad.
- A-R item on transfer earnings excluded from NI; GNP deflator rise lowers purchasing power; APSES SDP definition asked word for word.
- Other PSCs favour formula-statement items (NNP = GNP - depreciation, NI = NNP_MP - (IT - subsidies)) and 'best measure of growth = per capita real income'.

AP state finances - revenue receipts and expenditure, debt and interest payments, latest AP Budget (11 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks AP finances as single-number recall from the latest Budget/Socio-Economic Survey: debt-GSDP (34.14% BE 2024-25, 32% Dec 2022), revenue receipts 2018-19 (Rs 1,57,599 cr), interest payments, scheme allocations (Rythu Bharosa Rs 8,750 cr, Agri Gold 11.5 lakh victims/Rs 1,150 cr).
- Options are deliberately close numbers (31.46/32.60/33.71/34.14), so year and BE/RE/actual distinctions are the trap.
- Concept items are basic: developmental vs non-developmental (defence), ad valorem tax, Art. 280 FC; occasional statement pairs (capex <15% in 2016-21).

Banking in India - nationalisation, structure, priority sector, small finance and payments banks (10 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks direct dates/counts: 1969 and 1980 nationalisation, 19 July 1969, 14 banks; Lead Bank Scheme tied to bank nationalisation.
- AP tilt: founder of Andhra Bank (Pattabhi Sitaramayya), SBI slogan/logo and bank-emblem items, ICICI-Videocon 'sweetheart' lending.
- Other PSCs repeat: Oudh Commercial Bank 1881, first RRB 1975, SBI 1955, chronology RBI-SBI-LIC-1969, deposits are not bank assets, Service Area Approach under Lead Bank Scheme, NABARD as apex rural credit body.

Information technology and e-governance in Andhra Pradesh - IT policy, RTGS, e-Pragati (9 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks single-fact AP e-governance items: which CM launched e-Pragati (Naidu), MeeSeva start (Nov 2011), MANA TV for MeeSeva training, MEDHAS full form / sector, CARD award finalist.
- Policy questions use the 'NOT a target' shape (Electronics Mfg Policy 4.0: 2 lakh entrepreneurs is the odd one out).
- Location recall: IT/ITES SEZ = Visakhapatnam; Fiber Grid Phase-I covered 13 districts.

Related UNDP indices - IHDI, Gender Inequality Index, Gender Development Index, Multidimensional Poverty Index (8 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks single facts: MPI (2010) replaced HPI; GDI/GEM indicate gender inequality; National MPI estimated by NITI Aayog (G2 2025).
- Global MPI 2018 data recur in APPSC G2: 271 million out of poverty (2005-06 to 2015-16), Bihar poorest state.
- Other PSCs test year of introduction (HPI 1997, GII HDR 2010) and MPI dimensions/indicators (standard-of-living indicator odd-one-out).
- Statement traps: MPI is not '$1 a day'; National MPI does use Alkire-Foster; MPI = headcount x intensity (not sum); rural decline larger than urban.

Industrial policy - resolutions of 1948, 1956, 1977, 1980 and the New Industrial Policy 1991 (8 APPSC Qs)

- Year one-liners dominate: first industrial policy = 1948, IPR 1956 = Economic Constitution, licence raj abolished 1991, liberal policy year 1991.
- APPSC asks feature questions: IPR 1948 defined public and private spheres; IPR 1956 provisions (licensing, public sector, small industry); 51% FDI only in high-priority industries.
- Numbers recur: 18 licensed industries in 1991, 24% equity in SSI, arms and ammunition opened May 2001.

Geography (India, World & AP)

Disaster management framework - hazard vs disaster, DM Act 2005, NDMA, early warning systems (63 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks single-fact years repeatedly: DM Act 2005, NPDM 2009, HPC Aug 1999, NDMA 2005/Sept 2006, first NDMP 2016, CWC flood forecasting 1958, APSDMA 2007.
- Heads of bodies are a staple: NDMA = Prime Minister, DDMA = DM/Collector ('any of them'), SDMA set up by Governor under s.14(1).
- Many APPSC items are conceptual one-liners on the DM cycle: risk assessment/vulnerability analysis = mitigation, non-structural mitigation = awareness, recovery not pre-disaster, IMD orange = be prepared.
- GIS/remote-sensing applications appear often as 'which is INCORRECT' with an absurd overclaim option (GIS directly locates victims, completely resolves social issues).

Andhra Pradesh - drainage: Godavari, Krishna, Penna, Vamsadhara, Nagavali; reservoirs and canals (27 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks drainage as one-fact identification: 'X dam/project is on which river' (Srisailam, Somasila, Polavaram, Nagarjuna Sagar, Basava Sagar), 'river rises where' (Penna - Nandi hills), 'meets sea in which district' (Penna - Nellore), 'Gandikota on which river'.
- Recurring numbers: Godavari 1,465 km; 40 rivers / inter-state count; Tungabhadra forms 58 km AP-Karnataka boundary; Godavari 2 distributaries at Dowleswaram; Penna 536 km in AP. Wording decides the key ('longest' was keyed Godavari in 2025 and Penna in 2022).
- Project-purpose questions: Polavaram = National Project (Sec 90), Pattiseema = lift irrigation linking Godavari-Krishna (Limca record A-R), Telugu Ganga = Chennai/Tamil Nadu, KRMB allocates Srisailam water, NW-4 = Krishna waterway.

Andhra Pradesh - soil types and their distribution (26 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC repeatedly asks one fact: red soil covers the largest area of AP (~66%) - asked in 8+ recruitment papers with near-identical wording.
- Other recurring AP items: deltaic alluvium = most fertile / most important for agriculture in K-G deltas; laterite ~1%, acidic, poor fertility; skeletal soils on eroded hill slopes; black soil = Regur/Vertisols.
- Trap statements: 'laterite formed in semi-arid low rainfall' (incorrect); very deep black soils in north-western Deccan.
- APPSC uses short A-R and 'which are correct' items about AP soil distribution (Nallamala skeletal soils, laterite for horticulture).

India - Peninsular drainage: east-flowing and west-flowing rivers, river basins, watershed (24 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks direct one-liners: origin (Krishna-Mahabaleshwar), largest tributary (Pranhita / Tungabhadra), second largest basin (Godavari), which river is NOT west-flowing.
- AP tilt: Krishna's course (Mahabaleshwar-Sangli-Hamsaladeevi), Tungabhadra as Krishna tributary, Jayamangala-Pennar, NSTR on Krishna, Gokak falls-Ghataprabha.
- Other-PSC staples: west-flowing rivers have estuaries not deltas, rift-valley Narmada/Tapi, Amarkantak sources, waterfall-river pairs, lake-state pairs.
- Trap facts: Tapi lies between Satpura and Ajanta (not Vindhya); Pranhita = Wardha + Wainganga; Kosi is left-bank; Hagari = Vedavathi joins Tungabhadra.

India - rocks and mineral belts; distribution of metallic and non-metallic minerals (24 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks single-fact place->mineral items (Kolar = gold, Bailadila haematite, Khetri/Malanjkhand copper, Kadapa asbestos, AP sole producer of apatite) and ore->metal items.
- Recurring AP angle: mica (Nellore), asbestos/barytes (Kadapa), Vizag iron ore exports to Japan, rare earths in Anantapur (NGRI 2023), mineral-production shares 2021-22 (Odisha 44.11%).
- APPSC also asks belt A/R (South-Western vs North-Eastern plateau), NW non-ferrous = copper, phlogopite/pegmatite = mica, placer = gold, first list of 30 critical minerals.

World - major rivers, lakes, seas, straits, canals and islands (23 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks single-fact superlatives: longest river of Asia (Yangtze), deepest lake (Baikal), longest coastline (Canada), highest waterfall Angel Falls (3,212 ft), Dead Sea depth (1,385 ft).
- APPSC likes 'which is NOT' items (Victoria not a Great Lake) and river-mouth facts (Danube -> Black Sea, Mississippi -> Gulf of Mexico); its key uses Gulf of Mexico, not 'Atlantic'.
- Other PSC/UPSC staples: Mekong not through Malaysia, Caspian not bordering Armenia/Iraq, Black Sea not Croatia/Syria, Kiel = North Sea-Baltic, Michigan wholly in USA, Victoria Falls on Zambezi.
- Many filed PYQs are political geography / current affairs, not physical water bodies.

India - the Northern Plains, the Peninsular Plateau, the Coastal Plains and the Islands (21 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks direct one-liners: which range has Kashmir/Kangra/Kullu valleys (Himachal), Shiwalik valleys = Duns, Lakshadweep capital Kavaratti, Barren = volcanic, Luni in Indian desert.
- Recurring facts: Sahyadri passes Bhorghat/Thalghat (vs Goran ghat trap), Satpura between Narmada-Tapi, Malwa in W MP + SE Rajasthan, Peninsular Plateau rich in metallic minerals, Ooty in Nilgiris.
- APPSC 2022 Group-IV style uses simple match-the-following and 'select all that apply' statement items with obvious distractors (Sahara in India).
- Other PSCs favour Ghats meeting point (Nilgiri), Anaimudi highest in South India, Dandakaranya states, Chota Nagpur minerals.

Earthquakes - causes, seismic waves, measurement, distribution, effects (19 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC repeatedly asks seismic zone of a place: Delhi = Zone IV, Visakhapatnam = Zone II, AP = Zones II-III, Kutch/North-East = Zone V, least active = Zone II.
- Basic terms: epicentre has maximum intensity, seismology definition, seismograph as instrument, earthquakes cannot be predicted.
- Statement traps on focus vs epicentre ('epicentre directly below the focus' is wrong) and causes of tremors (meteor impacts).
- Occasional world facts: 1960 Chile M 9.5, Japan most earthquake-prone.

Hydrological disasters - floods, flash floods, cloudbursts, droughts, tsunamis, storm surges (19 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC favours headline numbers from NDMA vulnerability profile: 58.6% landmass earthquake-prone, >40 mha flood-prone, ~5,700 km coast cyclone/tsunami-prone.
- Tsunami basics recur: Japanese origin, submarine earthquakes, slows near shore with height rising, 2004 origin Indian Ocean, worst-hit Tamil Nadu.
- Drought items use IMD deficiency thresholds (>50% = severe) and local Indian drought terms; flood items ask causes and expert-committee years (RBA, 2012 committee).
- AP angle: most cyclone-prone state, Rayalaseema drought, Budameru/Vijayawada floods, coastline rank after 2024 remeasurement.

Transport in Andhra Pradesh - highways, railway network, ports (Visakhapatnam, Krishnapatnam, Gangavaram, Kakinada), airports (18 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks port-location one-liners repeatedly (Krishnapatnam = Nellore asked 3+ times; Gangavaram = deep-water port; Bhogapuram near Vizag).
- Current-affairs statement items on AP projects are common: Errupalem-Nambur line (timeline trap), Vijayawada station green rating (IGBC vs LEED trap), airport losses, Kadapa-Renigunta highway.
- Count/rank facts: number of international airports (3), coastline rank (2nd on old 974 km; now 3rd), Vizag port traffic rank, NH-44 length.

The universe and the solar system - origin theories, the Sun, planets, asteroids, comets, meteors (17 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks one-line facts: light year = distance, most abundant element = hydrogen, Venus like Earth in size/mass, fastest planet Mercury, perihelion, blue moon = second full moon in a month, Steady State = Bondi & Gold.
- APPSC dated current-affairs astronomy: total solar eclipse 22 July 2009, annular eclipse 15 Jan 2010, 2018 'blood moon', Blue Marble (Apollo 17).
- Other PSCs repeat superlatives (largest, hottest, densest, no moons), Big Bang evidence (red shift, CMB), Chandrasekhar limit, comet tail away from Sun, eclipse geometry.

Atmospheric disturbances - tropical cyclones, temperate cyclones, anticyclones, thunderstorms, tornadoes (17 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks direct naming/scale facts: North Atlantic = hurricanes, China/Japan = typhoons, Saffir-Simpson = hurricanes, EF scale = tornadoes, IMD cyclonic storm 62/63-88 km/h.
- APPSC G1 2024 tested extra-tropical cyclone features ('no clear frontal system' is the incorrect statement); formation belt 30N-30S; cyclones form over oceans.
- Disaster angle: Odisha super cyclone 1999, IMD colour codes (post-landfall outlook = red), geo-informatics role, 2019 Arabian Sea cyclone names.
- PYQ pool here is noisy: many keys/topics wrong (Mohs, monsoon, islands), so trust consistent APPSC keys only.

India - natural vegetation types and their distribution; forest cover (India State of Forest Report) (17 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks species-to-forest-type items (mahogany/ebony/rosewood = tropical evergreen; rosewood-teak-acacia-sundari match), most widespread type (tropical deciduous), Shola = Nilgiri/Anaimalai/Palani temperate forests.
- AP tilt: Seshachalam = dry deciduous, Coringa = tidal mangroves, AP forest cover from ISFR (29,137.40 sq km in 2019), TOFI programme, AP mangrove rank.
- ISFR figures are asked directly (forest cover 21.54% in 2017; 24.56% forest+tree in 2019; 36% fire-prone in ISFR 2015).
- Trap: 'largest single type' - UPSC 2010 key says tropical moist deciduous, but an Uttarakhand 2024 key (FSI 2011 atlas) says tropical dry deciduous; APPSC sidesteps by asking 'tropical deciduous' together.

World - continents, major mountain systems, plateaus, plains and deserts (16 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks single-fact location items: highest peak of a continent (Kilimanjaro, Kosciuszko), where a desert lies (Sonoran, Great Victoria), what Sierra Nevada is.
- Ordering items: continents by area and largest countries (APPSC G1 descending order Russia, Canada, USA, China); India 7th.
- South America map facts recur: Pacific coastline countries (not Venezuela), landlocked Bolivia/Paraguay, Andes countries, Tropic of Capricorn.
- APPSC G1 also asks harder regional-physiography names (Tsaidam basin, Yukon plateau, Karakoram between Pamir and Indus).

India - location, extent, frontiers, standard meridian and neighbouring countries (15 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks which state does/does not border a neighbour (Myanmar: not Assam) and which state does not border AP (Kerala).
- AP-specific location facts recur: eastern boundary Bay of Bengal, longitudinal extent 76°47'E-84°50'E, Zone/coastline figures.
- Numeric one-liners: land border 15,106.7 km, revised coastline 11,098.81 km (2025), coastal states/UTs count.
- India-Sri Lanka separation (Gulf of Mannar / Palk Strait) and Lakshadweep as coral islands are repeated APPSC items.

Science, Technology & Environment

Relevance of science and technology to day-to-day life - health, food, transport, communication, household (56 APPSC Qs)

- Overwhelmingly direct one-liners: vitamin -> deficiency/chemical name, gland -> hormone/location, household chemical -> formula (baking soda $NaHCO_3$, Teflon = PTFE, milk of magnesia).
- APPSC-specific repeats: non-stick coating = Teflon/PTFE (3 times), sodium benzoate preservative, cola = phosphoric acid, PVC dialysis tubes, adrenal on kidney, kwashiorkor oedema.
- Common shapes elsewhere: 'not correctly matched' pairs, A/R on everyday physics (pressure cooker, altitude boiling point, myopia lens).
- Recent APPSC current-science items: Rhodamine B cotton-candy ban (2024), ultrasound for foetus A/R, 'decreased privacy not a positive impact'.

Goals of sustainable development - the 17 SDGs, targets and India's SDG Index performance (25 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC repeatedly asks 'how many SDGs' (17), target year (2030), year adopted (2015) - at least ten near-identical items.
- Goal number -> title is the next most common shape (Goal 1 No Poverty, 2 Zero Hunger, 4 Quality Education, 6 Water & Sanitation, 8 Decent Work), plus 'which is NOT an SDG' (e.g. 'Life in sky').
- Match items pair SDGs with descriptions, socio-economic challenges or Indian schemes (Namami Gange = SDG 6, Ujjwala = clean energy, Ayushman Bharat = health, Samagra Shiksha = education).
- APPSC also asks SDG India Index (NITI Aayog) results: weakest goals (2 and 5 in 2020-21) and drivers of improvement (6 and 7).

Environmental hazards and disaster management - DM Act 2005, NDMA and NDRF, Sendai Framework, disaster types and mitigation (23 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks direct single-fact items: Sendai target year (2030), Target E (2020), Bhopal gas (MIC), Operation Vanilla (Madagascar), NIDM southern campus, nodal ministry (MHA).
- Statement items on DM Act 2005 NDMA powers (lays down policy, approves National Plan and ministry plans) and Yokohama 1994 / IDNDR dates recur.
- Conceptual DRR items: Disaster Crunch (Pressure-and-Release) model - vulnerability rooted in socio-economic processes; post-2015 frameworks trap (Hyogo NOT one).
- Classification questions ('which type of disaster is avalanche/biological flooding') and earthquake-resistant design (small, centrally located openings) appear.

Health and environment - vector-borne and water-borne diseases, air pollution and health, antimicrobial resistance, One Health (22 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks single-fact items: dengue lowers platelets, filariasis (lower-limb swelling), Fasciola invades liver, Gambusia for malaria control, ringworm = fungi, brucellosis = bacteria, air pollution hits respiratory system.
- Odd-one-out 'vector is not a mosquito' (leishmaniasis/kala-azar, sleeping sickness, plague) and 'not water-borne' (kwashiorkor, TB, hepatitis B, fluorosis) recur across PSCs.
- Pathogen-type classification (virus/bacteria/protozoa/fungus) and bird flu H5N1 vs swine flu H1N1 are frequent; other PSCs add Fleming-penicillin, Waksman, Widal/Mantoux tests.
- Recent APPSC Forest papers add livestock diseases (FMD, bovine TB, Chagas vector) and State of Global Air figures.

Environment - components; ecology, ecosystem, food chain and food web, energy flow, ecological pyramids (17 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks direct one-liners: basic functional unit of ecology, first trophic level members (phytoplankton, vent bacteria, seaweeds), sequence of energy flow, secondary productivity definition, ecological pyramids as expression of trophic levels.
- Recurring APPSC keys: niche statements (both true), fundamental niche, carrying capacity definition, natality statements, standing crop/biomass, producers in terrestrial ecosystems.
- Traps: grazing chain starting with dead leaves, missing herbivore level, 'generating synthetic chemicals' as an environment function, inverted pyramids (pond biomass, parasitic/tree numbers), energy pyramid never inverted.
- Other-PSC PYQs add biomagnification (top predator), lichen/mycorrhiza partners, halophyte/xerophyte/hydrophyte terms, insectivorous plants and nitrogen-poor soil.

Solid waste, plastic waste, e-waste, biomedical and construction waste - rules and management (14 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks direct one-liners: biodegradable vs non-biodegradable item (tin, wool, peels), zero-waste city (Indore), 3R odd-one-out ('Regain'), urban disposal methods ('all the above').
- Rule-year-goal items recur: MSW Rules 2000 = segregation; PWM Amendment 2021 = SUP phase-out by 2022; EPR origin = E-waste Rules 2011 (UPSC).
- Strong AP/current-affairs tilt: CLAP launch date (2 Oct 2021) incl. assertion-reason, APPCB RDF in cement kilns, Water Plus cities, Swachh Survekshan themes.
- Disposal-method matching (organic-composting, e-waste-recycling, hazardous-incineration, glass-landfill) and WtE terms (pyrolysis, plasma gasification) are favourite match items.

International environmental treaties - Stockholm 1972, Rio 1992, Ramsar, CITES, CBD and its protocols (13 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks one-line identifications: Ramsar = wetlands, CITES = endangered species trade (Washington Convention), Nagoya = part of CBD, IUCN full form, International Year of Biodiversity 2010.
- Recent APPSC items probe definitions (Nagoya 'utilization of genetic resources' = R&D on genetic/biochemical composition) and CA conferences (CMS COP14 Samarkand 2024).
- Other PSCs test GEF facts, Montreux Record meaning, Cartagena = biosafety (MoEF nodal), UN Decade on Biodiversity 2011-20.

S&T institutions - ICAR, ICMR, ICFRE, DRDO, ISRO, DAE, DoS and their mandates (11 APPSC Qs)

- Overwhelmingly 'institute - location' single-fact items (CTRI Rajahmundry, NRCWA Bhubaneswar, NATMO Kolkata, NIO Goa, IIFM Bhopal, FRI Dehradun, NIV Pune).
- APPSC tilts to AP-located institutes and recent S&T news items (LIGO-India lead labs, ICAR lumpy skin vaccine, IIT research items).
- Mismatch-pair format ('not correctly matched') is common in other PSCs; APPSC mostly direct one-liners.

Earth observation - IRS series, Cartosat, Resourcesat, Oceansat, RISAT, EOS series and applications (11 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC tests remote-sensing basics: active sensor = laser, infrared sensors for volcanic heat, non-components/non-resolutions as traps ('minimisation', 'chemical').
- Direct identification: first mapping satellite = Cartosat-1, geo-imaging = EOS-03, NISAR = NASA-ISRO, INFFRAS, MODIS full form.
- Navigation-system owner match (Galileo = EU, GLONASS = Russia) recurs as 'incorrect pair'.

Applications of space technology - agriculture, disaster management, telemedicine, tele-education, navigation (11 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC's favourite shape: 'which CANNOT be monitored / is NOT an application' - answer is the human-health event, chemical soil testing, earthquake prediction or news channels.
- Direct recall of names/full forms: MOSDAC full form, Meghdoot (IMD+ICAR), QGIS as open-source GIS, digitizer as GIS hardware, Nabhmitra.
- GIS basics (store/manipulate/analyse/display) and NRSC flood-prone basin (Ganga-Brahmaputra) appear repeatedly.

Climate change - greenhouse effect, greenhouse gases, radiative forcing, evidence and observed impacts (10 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks one-line recall: 'which is NOT a greenhouse gas' (nitrogen, oxygen, hydrogen, argon), methane from lowland rice, what traps the sun's heat (GHGs).
- APPSC 2023-25 items probe concepts: water vapour raised only indirectly by humans, black carbon = short-lived incomplete-combustion pollutant, deforestation increases CO2 (incorrect-statement trap).
- Match-the-effect items (global warming -> sea level, air pollution -> respiratory illness) and oil spill / plastic burning effects recur.
- Other PSC filler is heavy on chemistry of gases (laughing gas, tubelights) that is not climate change; much of the PYQ pool here is misfiled.

Environmental legislation in India - Water Act 1974, Air Act 1981, Environment (Protection) Act 1986 (9 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks bare year/purpose items: EPA 1986, Air Act 1981, CPCB set up 1974, purpose of Air Act (air quality standards), EPA = protect and improve the environment.
- AP tilt: APPCB facts (1976, head office Vijayawada, zonal/regional offices, lab equipment).
- Other PSCs repeat: Water Cess 1977, Air Act year, Central Ground Water Authority under EPA (UPSC 2022).

Sustainable development - meaning, nature, scope and components (9 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks one-liners on summits: Rio 1992 (UNCED, Agenda 21, UNFCCC), Rio+20 outcome 'The Future We Want', CSD reviews Agenda 21.
- Definition origin: Brundtland Report 'Our Common Future' (1987) is repeatedly asked; 17 SDGs (AP adopted all 17, 212 indicators).
- Pillars questions: economic, social, environmental; distractors are military/political/cultural.
- Assertion-reason on economic sustainability appears (profit maximisation without social/environmental view = false).

Conservation - in-situ (protected areas, biosphere reserves) and ex-situ (zoos, gene banks, seed banks) (9 APPSC Qs)

- Core shape: 'which is NOT in-situ' with Botanical Garden as answer; cryobank medium = liquid nitrogen.
- Biosphere reserves asked as state-matching, first/largest, and which BRs are outside UNESCO's MAB network (APPSC G1 listed Cold Desert, Dibru-Saikhowa, Great Rann).
- APPSC AP tilt: Seshachalam = first/only AP BR; Naupada ICMBA in Srikakulam; 106 ICMBAs; Svalbard/Chang La seed-vault statements.
- Marine firsts recur: Gulf of Kachchh first marine NP/sanctuary, NCMB at Jamnagar, Gulf of Mannar marine BR.

Air pollution - sources, pollutants, NAAQS, AQI, National Clean Air Programme, stubble burning (9 APPSC Qs)

- APPSC asks single-fact items: natural source (forest fires), main urban source (automobiles), CO reduces blood O2 capacity, NCAP launch year (2019), NCAP as industrial-emission initiative.
- Acid rain is the most-repeated angle across PSCs: SO2 + NOx (trap options CO, CO2, O3, CH4, CFC); H2SO4 dominant; Taj marble damage by SO2.
- AP tilt: APPCB action plan (123 ULBs/17 corporations), Varanasi top PM10 cut, Swachh Vayu Survekshan winner (Indore) as current affairs.
- Other PSCs use NAQI pollutant lists, NCAP targets (20-30% by 2024; 40% by 2026), PRANA, cloud-seeding chemicals (silver iodide).

9. The one-page drill

1. Know it? Mark it. Don't use any trick on a question you know.
2. Half-know: strike "None of the above" and "Neither" first; strike anything you can disprove.
3. Two left in a NOT / INCORRECT question: prefer option 4.
4. Two left in a statement set: lean towards more statements true ("Both", "two of three") - "none" is rare.
5. A statement says exclusively / solely / entirely / any → suspect it false; first / largest / an AP fact → suspect it true.
6. Numbers / years: drop the smallest / earliest first.
7. Still stuck: the option sharing most words with the other three.
8. Blind (nothing ruled out): leave it - with 1/3 negative marking a blind guess gains nothing.